🇳🇬 OVERVIEW OF THE LASSA FEVER SITUATION IN NIGERIA

2020-2026

NIGERIA CENTRE FOR DISEASE CONTROL AND PREVENTION

World Health Organization

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- Thank you

DISCLAIMER

- **References**: Nigeria Centre for Disease control (NCDC), see here:

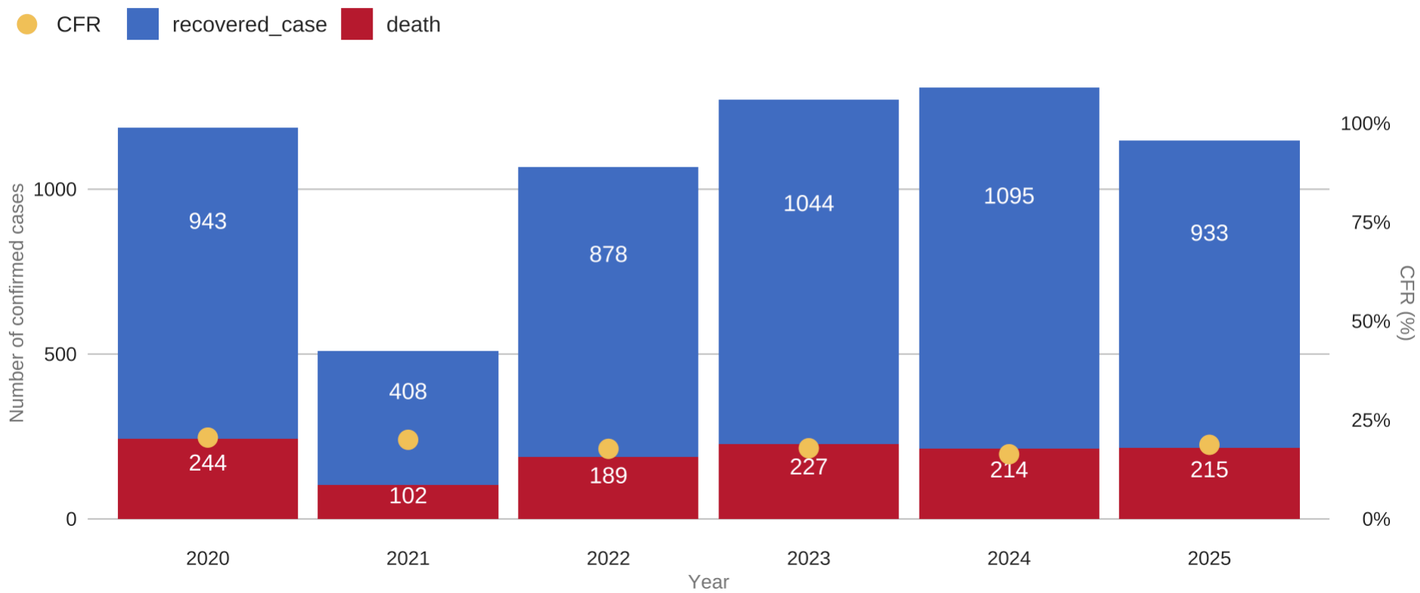
Nigeria Center for Disease Control and Prevention

- **More information**: for a dynamic report of the 🇳🇬 **Lassa fever situation in Nigeria** , go to 🔗

LASSA FEVER IN NIGERIA - DATA FROM 2020 TO 2025

THE OVERALL BURDEN OF LASSA FEVER IN NIGERIA

Cumulative number of confirmed Lassa fever cases and deaths with case fatality ratio (CFR) in Nigeria by year, 2020-2025



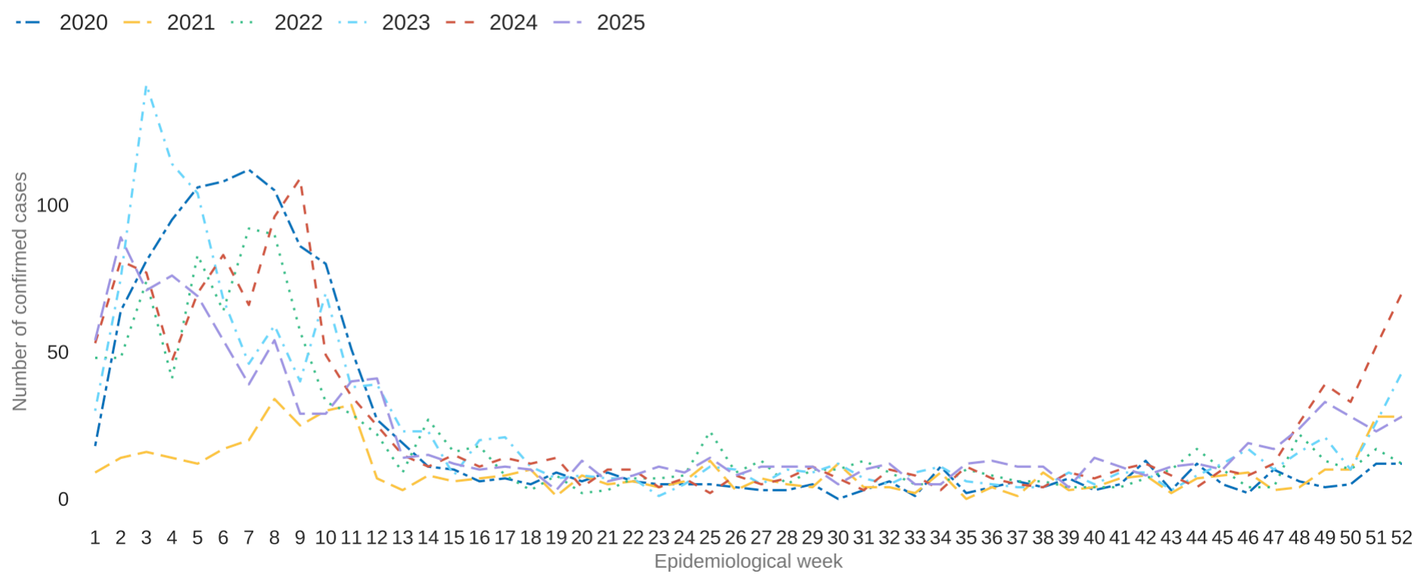
- Nigeria has the highest burden of Lassa fever cases in West Africa.
- Strengthening of capacity for lab diagnostics and case management in previous years resulted in greater case detection.
- Major LF outbreaks reported in since 2018, with **6492 confirmed cases** since 2020.

THE EFFECT OF SEASONALITY ON THE LASSA FEVER INCIDENCE

Confirmed cases | Suspected cases

Number of confirmed Lassa fever cases reported in Nigeria by week and year

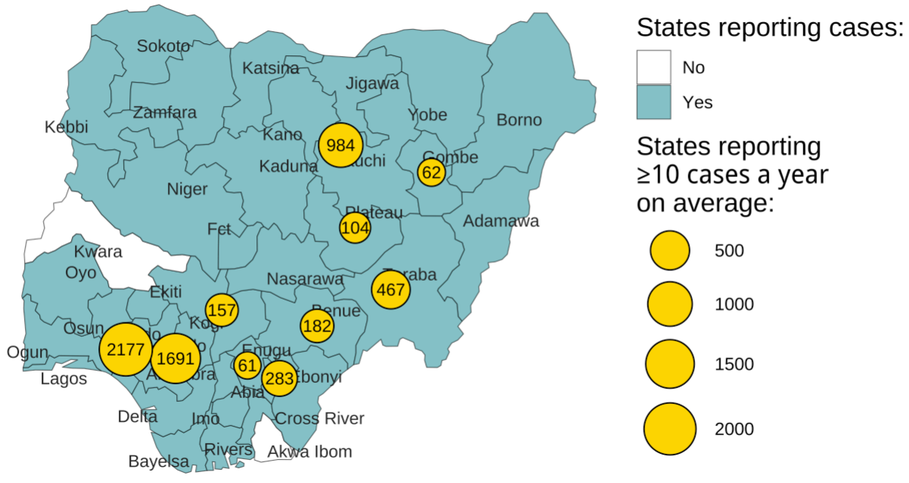
From 2020 to 2025



- Lassa fever cases in Nigeria by week show a seasonal effect: the number of cases peaks during the **dry season period** (from epi week 47 - week 12).
- The **seasonal increase** of cases during the dry period may be attributed to an increase of the infected rodent population and/or a seasonal behavioural change in the human population resulting in a higher risk of exposure to infected animals and/or to food/household items contaminated with rodent excreta.

LASSA FEVER IN NIGERIA: WHERE DO EFFORTS NEED TO FOCUS?

Lassa fever outbreak – overview from January 2020 to December 2025



States reporting cases:

No

Yes

States reporting ≥10 cases a year on average:

500

1000

1500

2000

source: Nigeria Center for Disease Control (NCDC)

From January 2018 to December 2025, **75% of Lassa fever confirmed cases** were from **Ondo** (34%), **Edo** (26%) and **Bauchi** (15%).

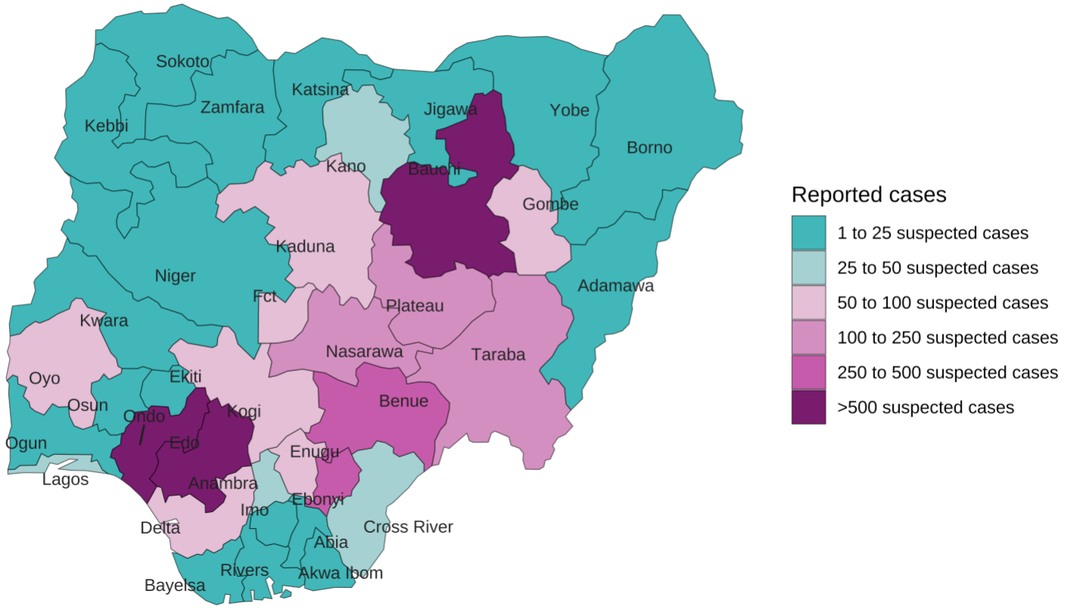
From January 2018 to December 2025:

- Total suspected cases: 49,413
- Total confirmed cases: 7,177
- Deaths from Confirmed Cases: 1,361
- Case Fatality Ratio: 21%
- Number of Health Care Workers: 276

LASSA FEVER SUSPECTED CASES, CONFIRMED CASES AND CFR BY STATE, NIGERIA 2020-2025

Suspected cases | Confirmed cases | CFR

Lassa fever suspected cases reported per year
2020-2025 (average per year)



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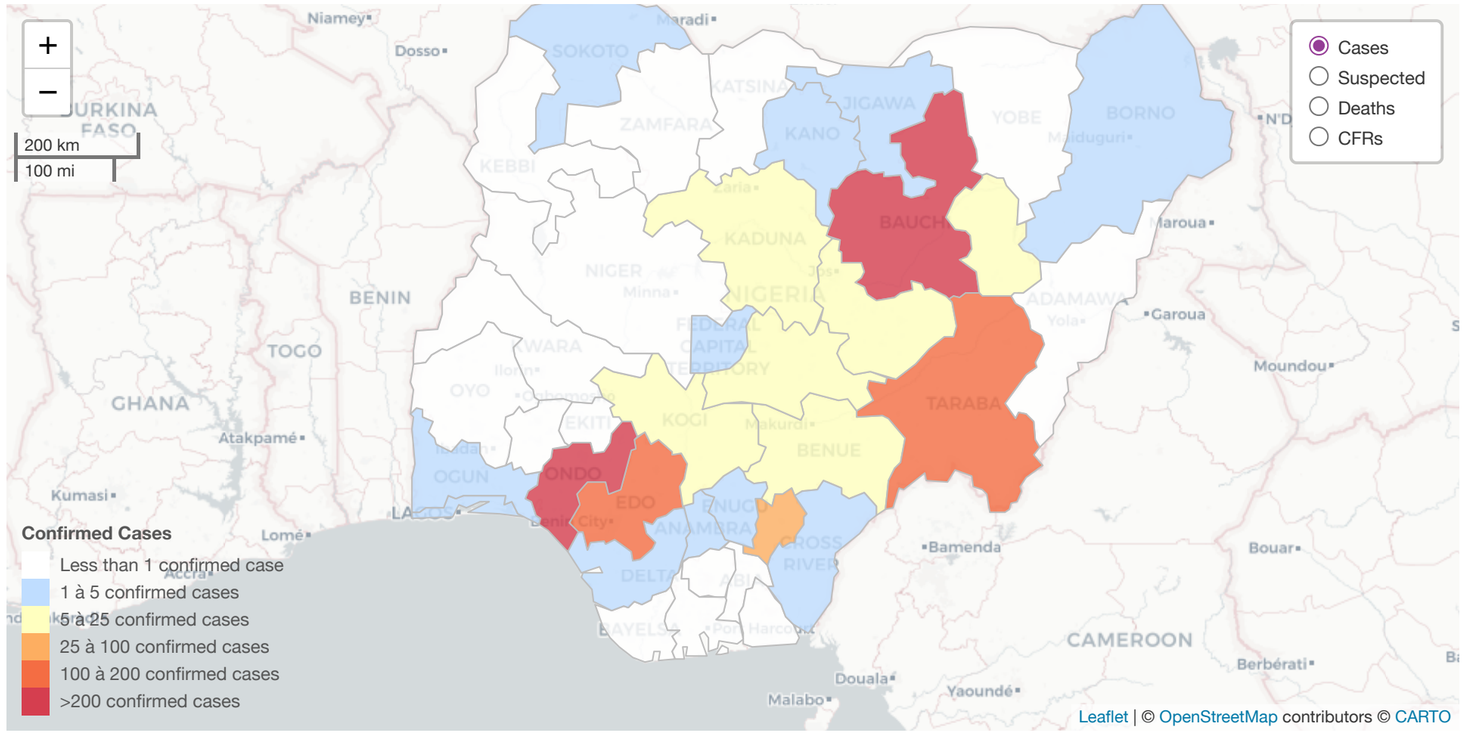
LASSA FEVER BY STATE, NIGERIA 2020-2024: INTERACTIVE MAPS

2025 | 2024 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020



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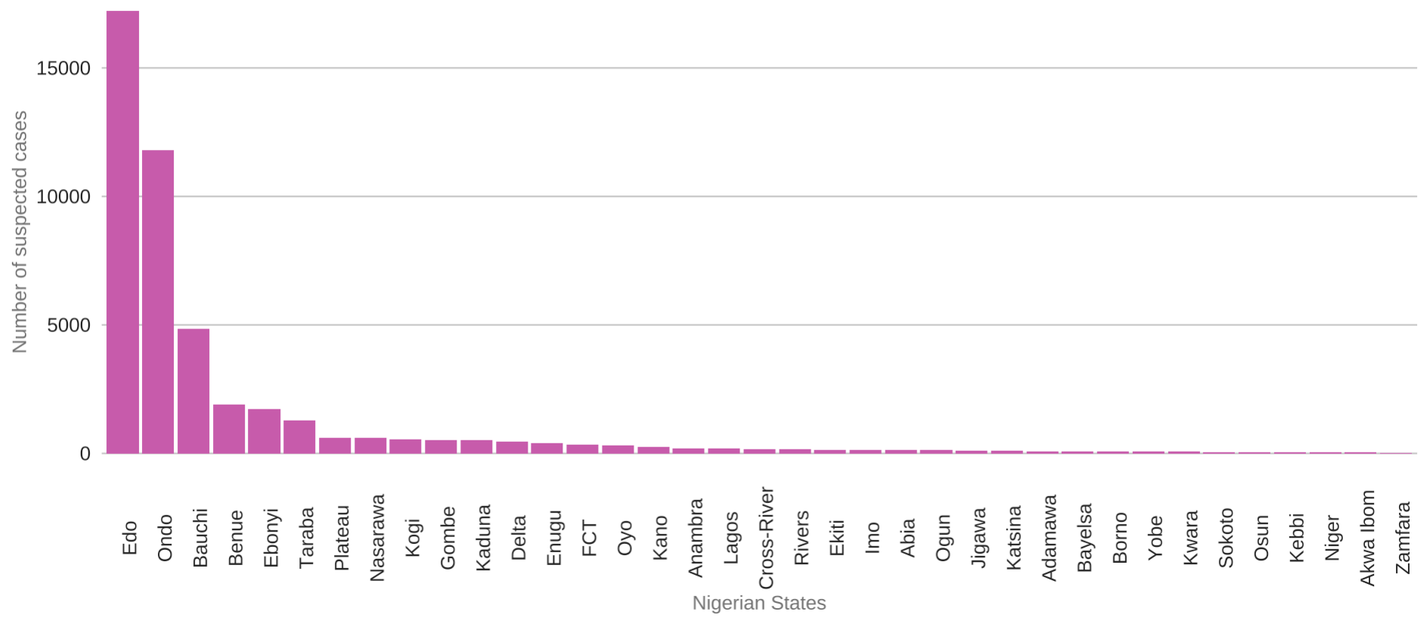
SUSPECTED CASES OF LASSA FEVER

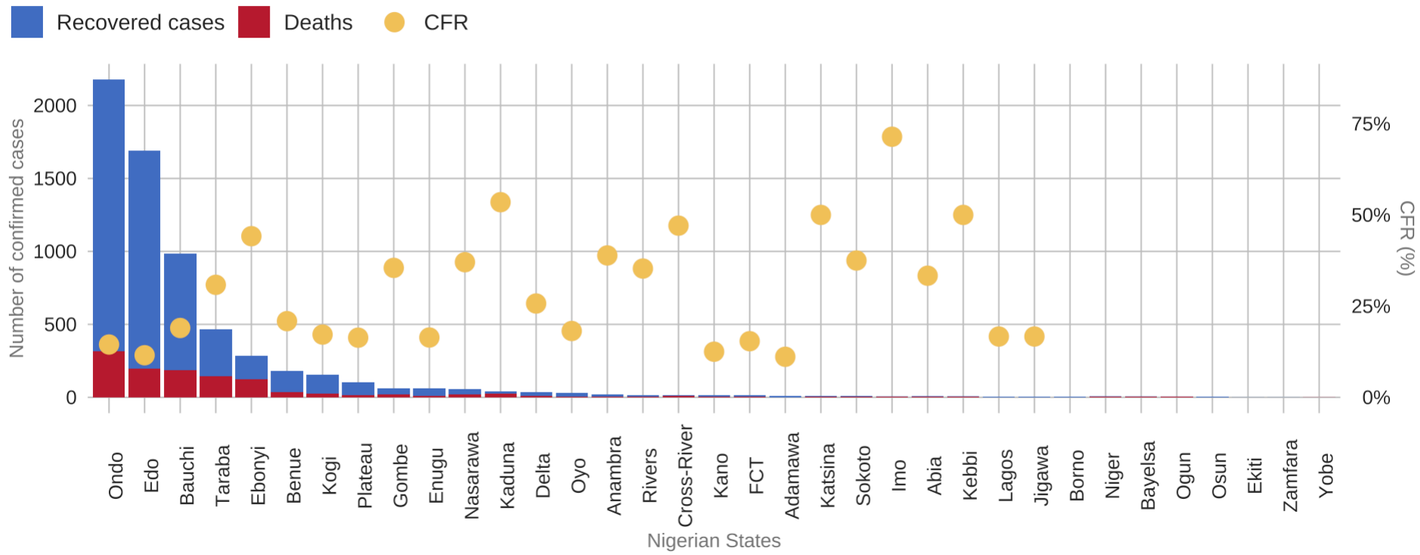
Cumulative number of suspected Lassa fever cases in Nigeria by state, 2020-2025



- From 2017-2025, a total of **45,411** suspected cases were reported from **29** in **Zamfara** to **17,224** in **Edo**.

CASE FATALITY RATE (CFR) AMONG CONFIRMED LASSA FEVER CASES

Cumulative number of confirmed Lassa fever cases and deaths with case fatality ratio (CFR) in Nigeria by state, 2020-2025

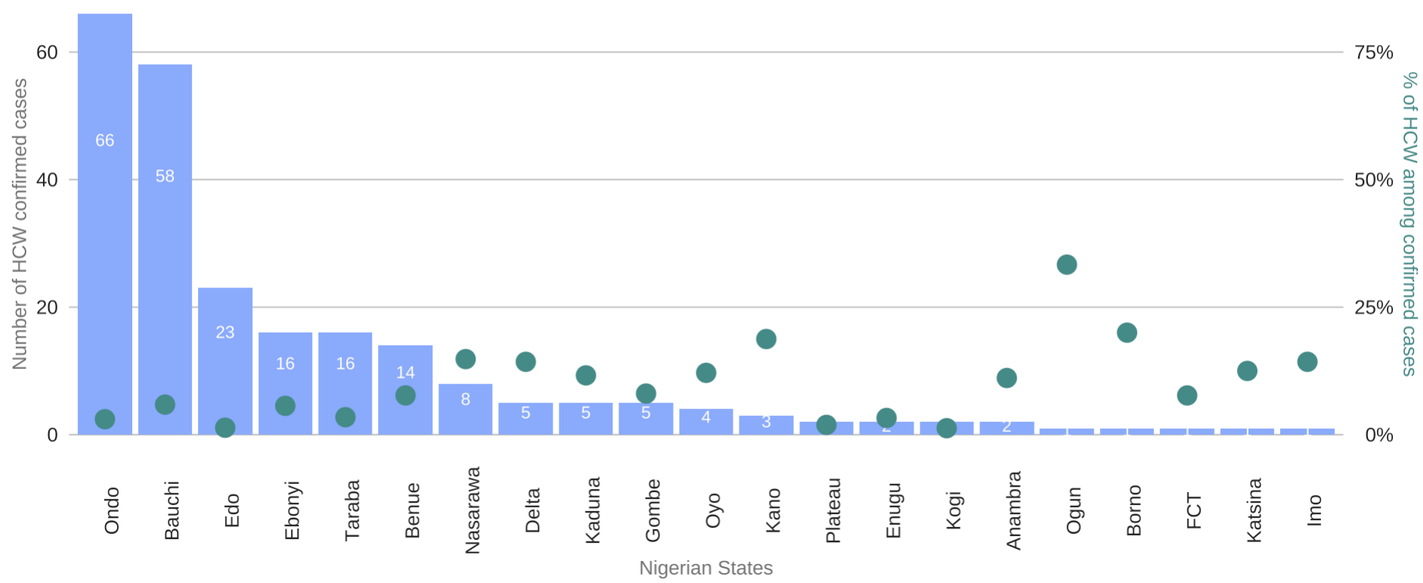


CFR presented if ≥5 confirmed cases reported.

- From 2017-2025, CFR among all lab confirmed cases in Nigeria was **between 17-27%** and **decreased** over time.
- In 2025, overall **CFR for Nigeria was 19%** and differed greatly by individual State.
- The variation in CFR is likely due to late patient presentation and differences in case management, highlighting the need for improvement.

LASSA FEVER INFECTIONS AMONG HEALTHCARE WORKERS

Cumulative number of confirmed HCW (n=236) by state and % among confirmed cases, 2020-2025

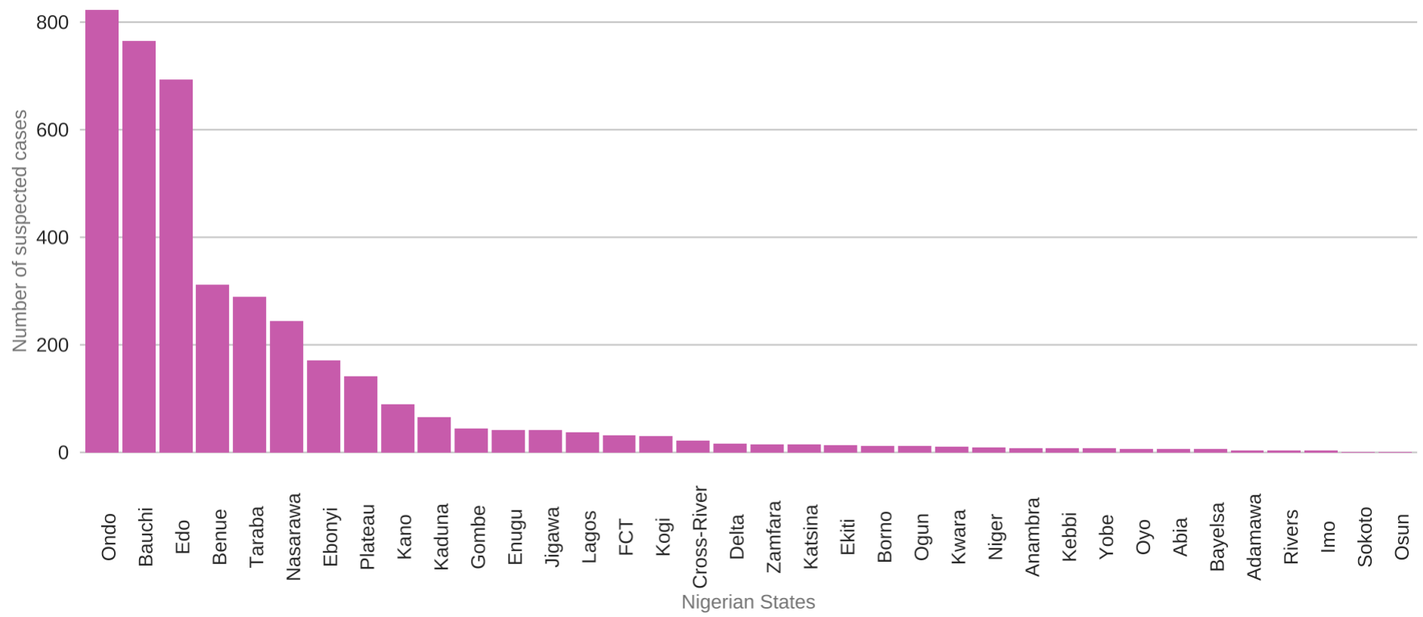


- From 2020-2025, a total of **236 healthcare workers (HCW)** were reported among confirmed cases, that is **4% of Lassa fever cases**.
- **Higher proportion of HCW** in States with low incidence (10-30%).

LASSA FEVER IN 2026 - DATA FROM EPI-WEEK 1 TO EPI-WEEK 14

SUSPECTED CASES OF LASSA FEVER IN 2026

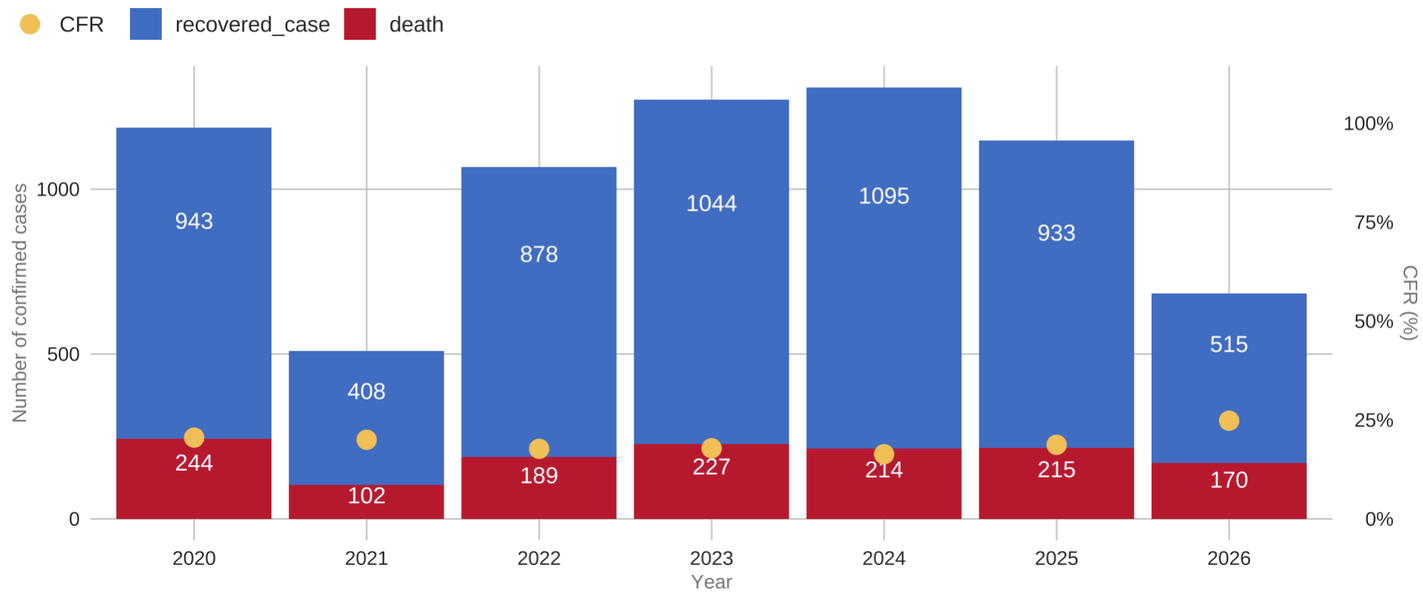
Cumulative number of suspected Lassa fever cases in Nigeria by state, 2026



- In 2026, a total of 4,002 suspected cases were reported from **1** in **Sokoto, Osun** to **823** in **Ondo**.

CUMULATIVE NUMBER OF CONFIRMED LASSA FEVER CASES IN 2026

Cumulative number of confirmed Lassa fever cases and deaths with case fatality ratio (CFR) in Nigeria by year, 2020-2026, epiweek 14



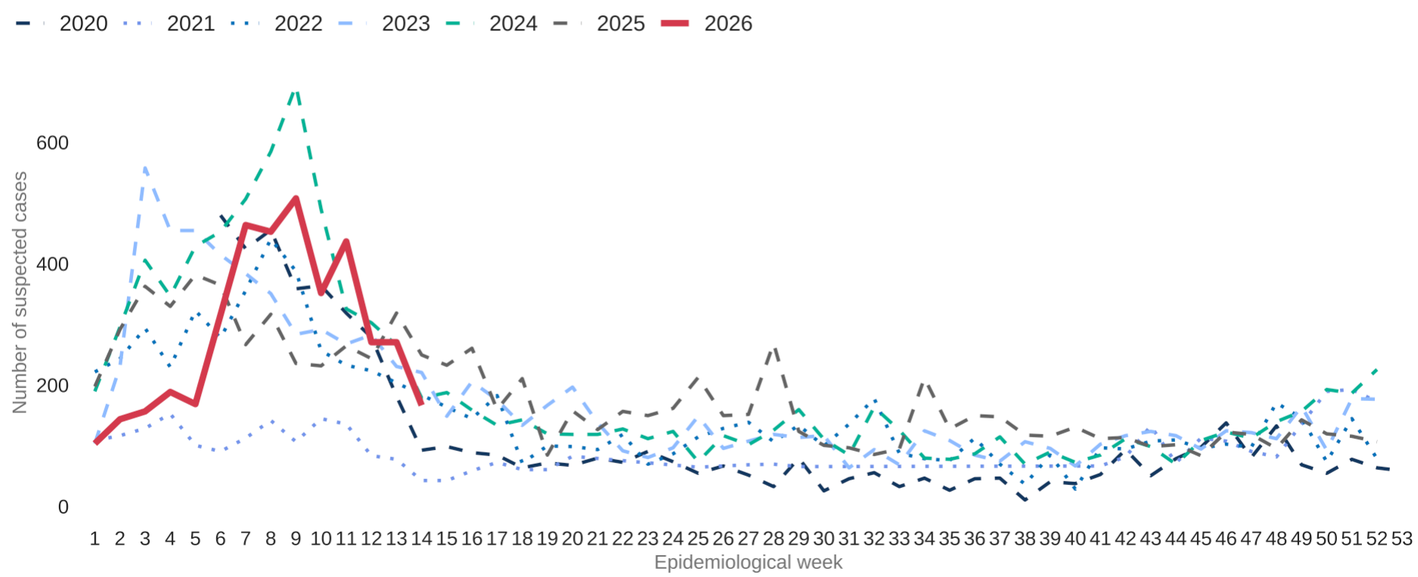
- Nigeria has the highest burden of Lassa fever cases in West Africa.
- Strengthening of capacity for lab diagnostics and case management in previous years resulted in greater case detection.
- Major LF outbreaks reported in since 2018, with **6492 confirmed cases since 2020**.

SEASONALITY OF LASSA FEVER

Suspected cases | Confirmed cases

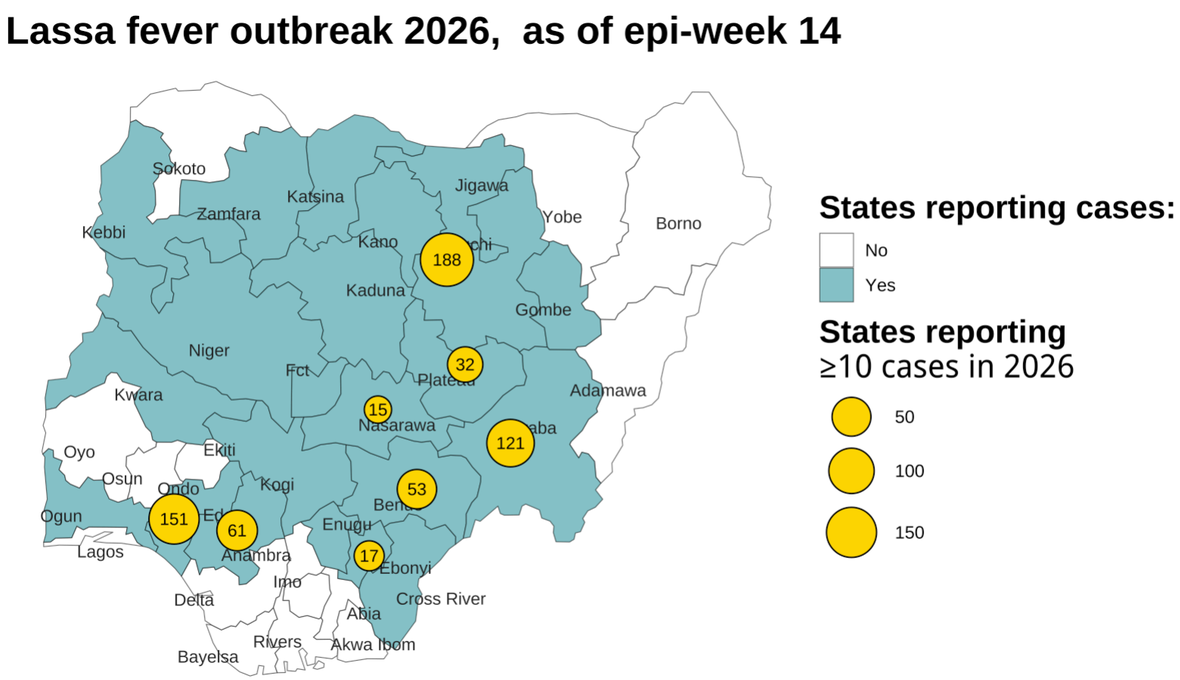
Number of suspected Lassa fever cases reported in Nigeria by week and year

From 2020 to 2026, epiweek 14



- Compared to 2025, **1% decrease** in the cumulative number of **suspected cases** reported.

STATES REPORTING LASSA FEVER CONFIRMED CASES IN 2026



source: Nigeria Center for Disease Control (NCDC)

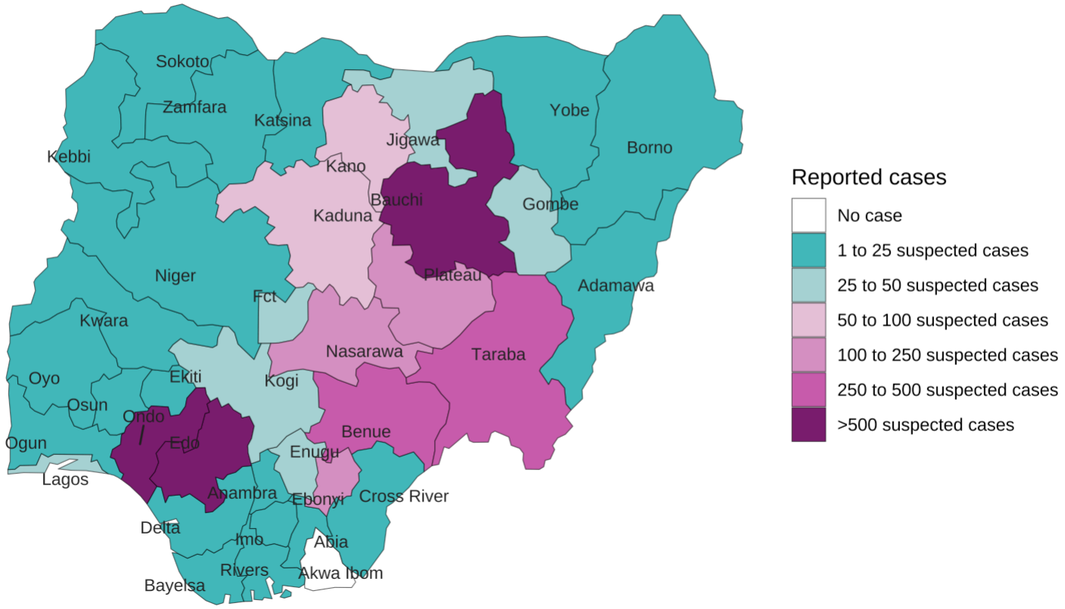
- In 2026, as of epi week 14, **76%** of LF cases are from Ondo (22%), Bauchi (27%), Edo (9%), and Taraba (18%) States.
- Total **confirmed cases**: 685
- **Deaths** from Confirmed Cases: 170
- **Case Fatality Ratio**: 25%
- Number of **Health Care Workers**: 40

LASSA FEVER SUSPECTED CASES, CONFIRMED CASES AND CFR BY STATE IN 2026

Suspected cases | Confirmed cases | CFR

Lassa fever suspected cases reported per year

2026, as of epiweek 14



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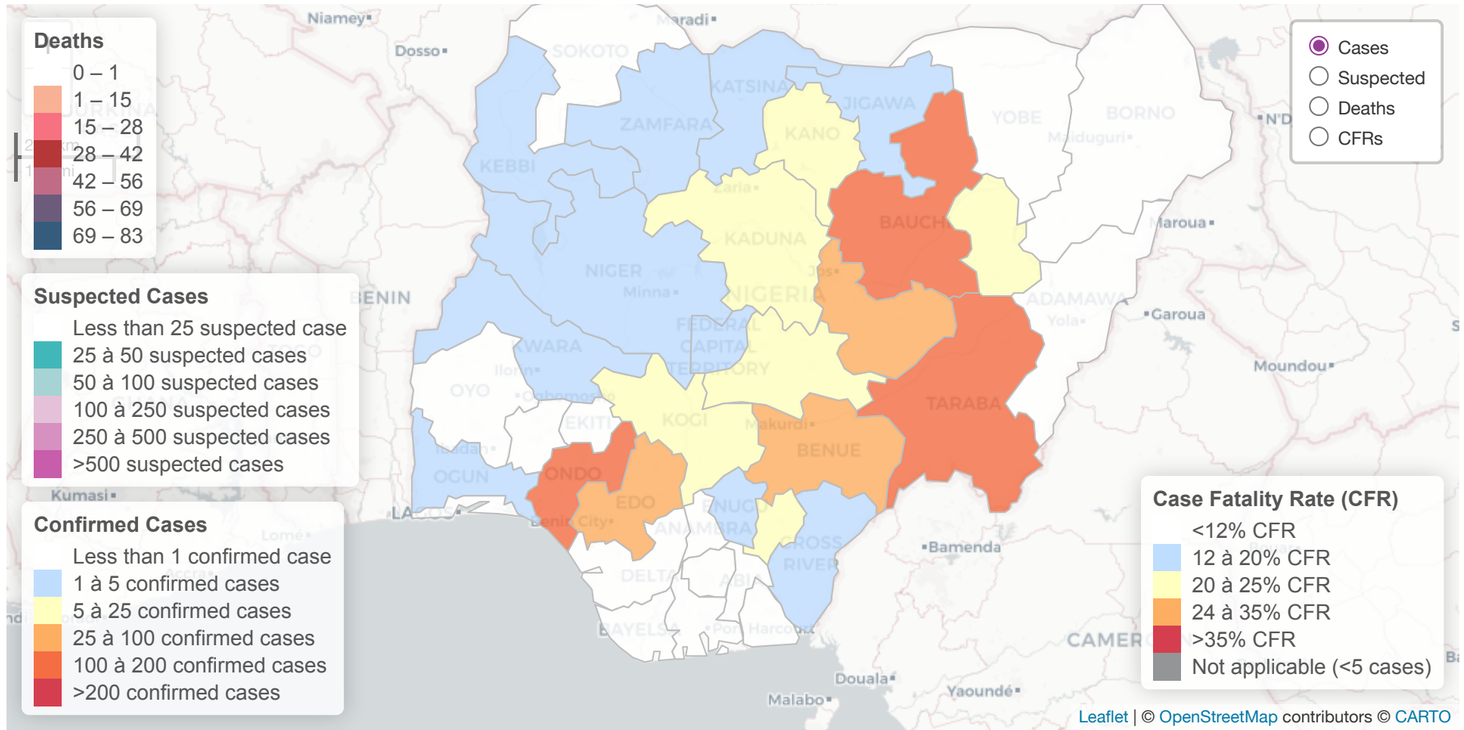
LASSA FEVER BY STATE, NIGERIA 2026: INTERACTIVE MAPS

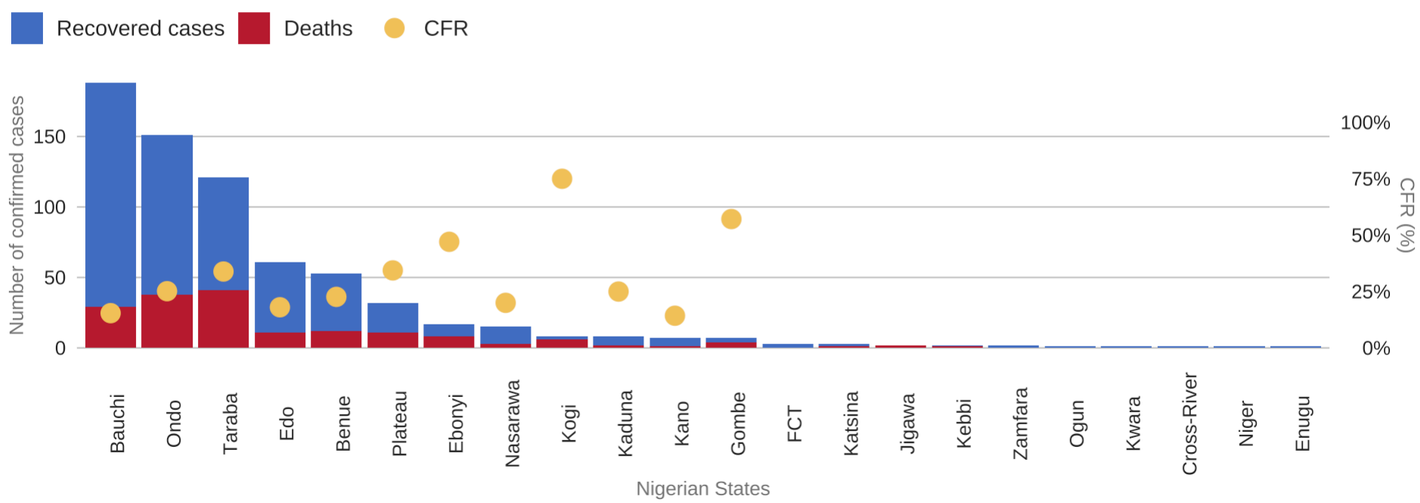
2026 | 2025



CASE FATALITY RATIO AMONG CONFIRMED LASSA FEVER CASES BY STATE IN 2026

Cumulative number of confirmed Lassa fever cases and deaths with case fatality ratio (CFR) in Nigeria by state

2026, as of epiweek 14

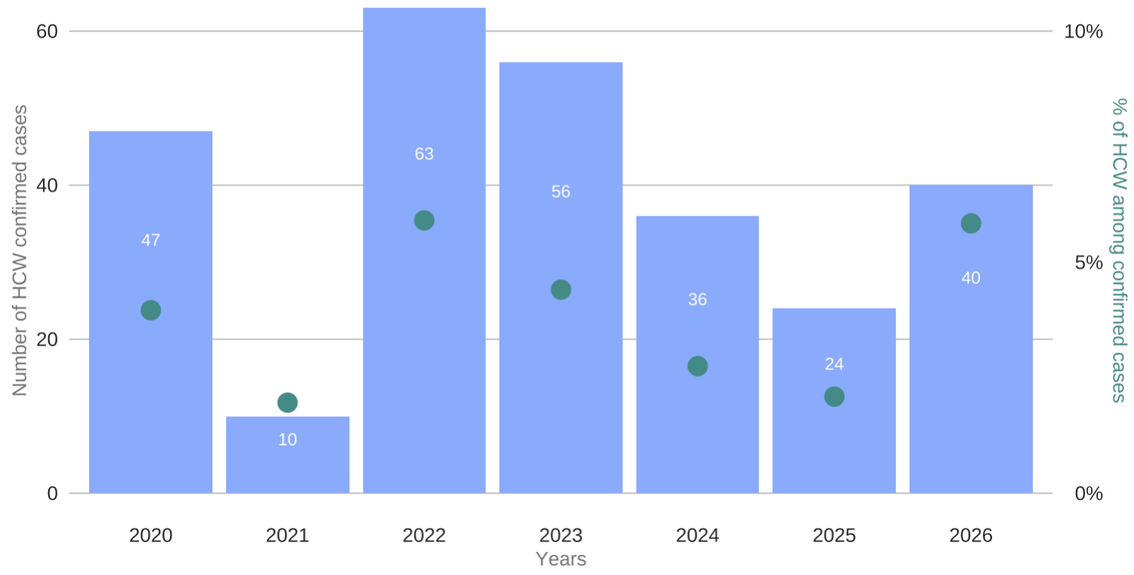


CFR presented if ≥5 confirmed cases reported.

- As of epi week 14 2026, **cumulatively 685 cases and 170 deaths (CFR=25%) across 22 States** have been reported.
- At same period 2025, a total of **18 States** reported at least one confirmed cases.
- There is a **1% decrease in the number of suspected cases reported in 2026** compared to 2025.
- There is a **2% increase in the number of confirmed cases reported in 2026** compared to 2025.
- In 2025,
  - **34 States** had reported at least one suspected case versus **36 States** in 2026 to date.
  - **18 States** had reported at least one confirmed case versus **22 States** in 2026 to date.

HEALTH CARE WORKER INFECTIONS 2020-2026 EPIWEEK 14

Number and % of confirmed cases among HCW (n=276) by state, 2020-2026



- **Top 5** states:
  - **14** HCW infections in **Benue**
  - **6** HCW infections in **Nasarawa**
  - **5** HCW infections in **Bauchi**
  - **4** HCW infections in **Ondo**
  - **3** HCW infections in **Taraba**.

- As of epi week 14 of 2026, there has been **40 healthcare workers** infected, that is **6% of confirmed cases**.

LASSA FEVER IN MOST AFFECTED STATES - DATA FROM 2020 TO 2026 (AS OF EPI-WEEK 14)

LASSA FEVER IN ONDO STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2024 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Ondo as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	823	151	38	25%
2025	1173	200	26	13%
2024	1140	195	13	7%
2023	1162	279	30	11%
2022	643	200	35	18%
2021	296	69	19	28%
2020	496	309	44	14%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

LASSA FEVER IN BAUCHI STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Bauchi as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	765	188	29	15%
2025	729	171	12	7%
2024	641	133	28	21%
2023	641	97	18	19%
2022	598	112	12	11%
2021	41	8	2	25%
2020	265	43	19	44%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

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LASSA FEVER IN EDO STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Edo as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	693	61	11	18%
2025	1204	107	17	16%
2024	1300	180	23	13%
2023	1593	247	31	13%
2022	1166	172	24	14%
2021	909	103	12	12%
2020	1091	314	39	12%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

LASSA FEVER IN TARABA STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Taraba as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	289	121	41	34%
2025	271	106	31	29%
2024	201	96	20	21%
2023	230	81	28	35%
2022	74	31	14	45%
2021	47	18	11	61%
2020	97	55	21	38%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

LASSA FEVER IN EBONYI STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Ebonyi as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	171	17	8	47%
2025	121	21	11	52%
2024	228	43	24	56%
2023	184	50	27	54%
2022	186	39	18	46%
2021	79	15	6	40%
2020	183	73	21	29%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

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LASSA FEVER IN KOGI STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Kogi as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	31	8	6	75%
2025	64	15	4	27%
2024	105	28	2	7%
2023	37	11	1	9%
2022	99	39	7	18%
2021	5	1	0	0%
2020	79	34	8	24%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

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LASSA FEVER IN GOMBE STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Gombe as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	44	7	4	57%
2025	63	13	7	54%
2024	25	3	1	33%
2023	31	6	0	0%
2022	106	17	7	41%
2021	3	0	0	–
2020	27	7	2	29%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

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LASSA FEVER IN BENUE STATE, 2020-2026

Overview | 2026 | 2025 | 2023 | 2022 | 2021 | 2020

- Below is an overview of Lassa fever suspected cases, confirmed cases, deaths and average CFR in Benue as of week 14:

Years	Suspected cases	Confirmed cases	Deaths	CFR
2026	312	53	12	23%
2025	62	9	4	44%
2024	1037	62	11	18%
2023	142	36	3	8%
2022	188	30	8	27%
2021	14	3	0	0%
2020	27	8	3	38%

Source: *NCDC*

- See other tabs for yearly data

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THANK YOU

Any questions or suggestions? Contact us: Anaïs Legand and Antoine Chaillon